

CRUZ CREATIVE



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15 PROMPTS THAT DON'T LOOK LIKE **CHATGPT.**

Graphics. Headshots. Hooks. Captions. Copy, paste, swap the [brackets], go.

YOU ALREADY HAVE THE TOOL. NOBODY TAUGHT YOU HOW TO ASK IT PROPERLY.

Most AI content looks like AI content because the prompt was vague. Every prompt in this pack fixes that one thing: it gives the tool enough direction to produce work that looks like *you* made it.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

1. Fill in the Brand Kit on the next page. Once. It takes five minutes. Don't skip it - you'll need it in almost every prompt.
2. Paste your Brand Kit at the top of any prompt that mentions it.
3. Copy the prompt, swap the [BRACKETS], re-read it if you want to adapt it further, send.
4. If the first answer is close but not right, say what's wrong in plain English. Don't start again.

ONE RULE

Never post the first output. AI drafts. You approve. Make sure everything fits your brand before it goes anywhere. With time you'll work out how to adapt these prompts and make them even more yours. Enjoy it! ❤️

YOUR BRAND KIT

Fill this in now. Save it. You'll paste it into half the prompts in this pack.

COPY THIS · FILL IT IN

MY BRAND KIT

Business: [what you sell, to whom, in one line]

Audience: [who buys, what keeps them up at night]

Tone: [pick 3: warm / blunt / funny / calm / premium / scrappy / expert / playful]

Words I use: [5 phrases you actually say out loud]

Words I never use: [elevate, unlock, dive in, game-changer, journey, and anything else that makes you cringe]

Colours: [hex codes, e.g. #15171C ink, #4FE3A0 mint]

Fonts: [heading font, body font]

Look and feel: [3 references, e.g. "clean editorial, high contrast, natural light"]

Sentence length: [short and punchy / medium / long and considered]

Emoji: [yes, sparingly / never]

Tip: add anything else that matters. You might be in a sensitive industry where certain phrases are off limits. Give it as much context as you can.

01 THE BRAND-CONSISTENT GRAPHIC

Fixes: the flat, grainy, obviously-AI graphic that makes your business look cheap.

Use in: ChatGPT (image generation), or any image model. Recommended: GPT2 or Nano Banana, the best for clear text with no AI gibberish.

COPY THIS PROMPT

You are an art director creating a branded social graphic.

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Create a [square 1:1 / vertical 4:5 / story 9:16] graphic for [platform].

Subject: [what the image shows]

Headline text on the image: "[your headline, 6 words max]"

Non-negotiables:

- Use ONLY these colours: [hex codes]. No other colours anywhere apart from the photo on the graphic.
 - Typography: use only typography from the brand kit.
 - Composition: one clear focal point, deliberate negative space, headline in the top third or bottom third, never centred over the subject.
 - Lighting: natural lighting. The photo has to look like it was taken on an iPhone, not too polished or AI looking.
 - Finish: no glow, no lens flare, no floating 3D shapes, no stock-photo smiles.
 - Texture: clear, premium, natural photo looking, no grain, not too many shapes.
 - Proportions: text should be the focal point of the graphic, not the image. Text has to take up at least 50% of the graphic. It has to be big and easy to read.
- Also never place the photo on top and the text at the bottom, it catches attention to the wrong thing. Make sure the headline grabs attention first and the photo is just supporting it.

Generate now

PROMPT CONTINUES ON THE NEXT PAGE →

01 THE BRAND-CONSISTENT GRAPHIC — CONTINUED

ADD-ON · IF YOU HAVE A REFERENCE STYLE YOU LIKE

I'm attaching a graphic in a style I like. Take that as a principle and apply it to my branding colours and typography. Only analyse the overarching style: the type of photos or elements, their style, the placement of elements.

ADD-ON · IF YOU HAVE A PRODUCT PHOTO TO FEATURE

Reference Product: I am attaching a photo of my actual product. Use this image as the reference for the product shown in the design. Elevate the product photo so it looks like it was captured by a professional commercial photographer while preserving the product's exact design. Do not change the shape, proportions, colours, materials, text, finish, or any defining details. Improve only the photography by enhancing lighting, clarity, reflections, shadows, sharpness and overall presentation. The product must remain an accurate representation of the original so customers receive exactly what they expect. Never invent, remove or modify product features. The final product should look identical to the reference, only professionally photographed and naturally integrated into the scene.

Tip: run it, then judge it. In ChatGPT you can click edit on the image you've generated, then comment in the top right, and give feedback on specific elements.

02 THE HEADSHOT THAT ISN'T PLASTIC

Fixes: the blurry cropped selfie, and the waxy AI face.

Use in: ChatGPT.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here are photos of me. Create a professional headshot that looks like a real photograph of this exact person.

CRITICAL: keep my actual face. Same bone structure, same skin texture, same eyes, same age, same hairline, same hair. Do not smooth, slim, whiten or "improve" anything. Real skin has pores, lines and asymmetry. Keep all of it.

Shot specification:

- Framing: head and shoulders, eye level, subject slightly off-centre
- Lens look: 85mm portrait, shallow depth of field, background softly out of focus
- Lighting: large soft key light at 45 degrees, gentle fill, natural catchlight in both eyes
- Background: [plain warm grey / dark charcoal / soft office bokeh / outdoor shade]
- Wardrobe: [what you actually wear to work]
- Expression: [relaxed half smile / calm and direct / mid-conversation, warm]
- Colour: natural, slightly desaturated, no orange skin, no HDR

No beauty filter. No airbrushing. No studio backdrop seams. It should look like a good photographer took it, not like software made it.

Generate now

PROMPT CONTINUES ON THE NEXT PAGE →

02 THE HEADSHOT THAT ISN'T PLASTIC — CONTINUED

THEN, SAME CHAT

Now create a matching LinkedIn cover banner, 1584 x 396 pixels.

Same lighting world and colour palette as the headshot, but no face. Keep the left third and the far right clear of detail, because my profile photo and text sit there.

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Include this line in bold caps, it has to fit in the right part of the visual. The text should say [insert text] in the best of the brand colours. It should be bold and visible. Please feel free to include any elements that will support the message of my company.

Generate now

Tip: upload photos taken in daylight, facing a window. Rubbish input, rubbish output. If AI can't see your face, it will make one up.

03 THE VOICE THAT SOUNDS LIKE YOU

Fixes: elevate, unlock, dive in, and every other word nobody says out loud.

Use in: ChatGPT, Claude, or any other trusted LLM. Do this in two steps.

STEP ONE · BUILD YOUR VOICE PROFILE

I'm going to paste 5 things I've written: [social posts / emails / anything I wrote myself, not AI].

Analyse them and give me a VOICE PROFILE covering:

- Average sentence length and rhythm
- Do I use fragments? Questions? Lists?
- My 10 most characteristic words and phrases
- How I open and how I close
- My humour, if any, and what kind
- What I never do

Be specific and unflattering where needed. I want the real pattern, not a compliment.

Here are the samples:

[paste 5 pieces]

PROMPT CONTINUES ON THE NEXT PAGE →

03 THE VOICE THAT SOUNDS LIKE YOU — CONTINUED

STEP TWO · WRITE WITH IT

Write a [LinkedIn post / Instagram caption / email] about [topic].

VOICE PROFILE:

[paste the profile from step one]

Rules:

- Banned words: elevate, unlock, dive in, delve, leverage, game-changer, journey, landscape, realm, testament, tapestry, "in today's fast-paced world", "it's not just X, it's Y"
- No em dashes. No rhetorical question openers. No "let's be honest".
- Contractions throughout. Write how people talk.
- One idea per post. Cut anything that isn't it.
- Open with the most specific line, not the most general one.
- End with something a human would actually say, not a call to action wearing a suit.

Length: [X words].

Give me three versions with different opening lines.

Tip: save your Voice Profile with your Brand Kit. It's the single most valuable thing in this pack.

04 THE PRODUCT SHOT WITHOUT THE STUDIO

Fixes: the flat kitchen-counter photo under a yellow light.

Use in: ChatGPT. Upload this one with the photo of the product, and make sure the product is on a relatively plain background.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's a photo of my product. Re-shoot it as a professional studio product photograph.

CRITICAL: keep the product exactly as it is. Same shape, same proportions, same colours, same label, same text on the packaging, same materials. Do not redesign, restyle or "improve" the product. Only the photography changes.

Re-shoot specification:

- Surface: [seamless matte backdrop in [colour] / natural stone / warm oak / brushed concrete]
- Lighting: large softbox key from the left, subtle rim light on the right edge, soft natural contact shadow beneath the product. No harsh reflections on the label.
- Angle: [three-quarter hero / straight-on / 45 degrees from above]
- Depth of field: shallow, product sharp front to back, background falling off gently
- Props: [none / one minimal prop that matches the product world]
- Colour grade: clean, true-to-life, slightly cool, no yellow cast
- Format: [1:1 for shop / 4:5 for feed / 9:16 for stories], product filling roughly 70% of the frame

Photorealistic. Commercial catalogue quality. No text, no logos added, no floating product.

PROMPT CONTINUES ON THE NEXT PAGE →

04 THE PRODUCT SHOT WITHOUT THE STUDIO — CONTINUED

THEN GET THE SCENE VERSION

Same product, same rules. Now place it in a real setting: [kitchen worktop in morning light / bathroom shelf / desk / picnic table outdoors].

Lifestyle, not staged. Slightly imperfect. Natural window light with soft shadows. Shot on a phone by someone with a good eye, not a studio crew. Human hand in shot: [yes / no].

Tip: shoot the original on a plain surface near a window. The cleaner the input, the less the model invents.

05 THE HOOK MACHINE

Fixes: first three seconds that lose everyone.

Use in: ChatGPT, Claude, or any other LLM.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I'm making a [reel / short / TikTok] about [topic] for [audience].

The point I want to land: [the one takeaway]

Write 15 opening lines. Spoken out loud, under 12 words each. They must work as the literal first sentence of the video.

Use a spread of these angles:

- The specific mistake they're making right now
- The thing they believe that's wrong
- The cost of doing nothing
- The comparison they'll recognise instantly
- The blunt confession
- The number that surprises

Rules:

- No "here's why", "let me tell you", "did you know", "stop scrolling"
- No questions unless the question is genuinely uncomfortable
- Concrete over clever. Name the actual thing, not the category.
- Write for the ear, not the eye

Then pick your top 3 and say in one line why each one earns the next five seconds.

Tip: read them out loud. If you'd feel daft saying it, bin it.

06 THE IDEA ENGINE

Fixes: being stuck for ideas.

Use in: ChatGPT, Claude, or any other LLM.

COPY THIS PROMPT

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

What I sell: [offer, price, who it's for]

What my buyers get wrong before they find me: [2 or 3 things]

Give me 30 content ideas for [platform] over the next month.

For each idea:

| Hook line | Angle | Format (talking head / carousel / demo / text) | Which of my offers it ladders to |

Spread them across:

- 10 that solve a small, specific problem in under 60 seconds
- 8 that challenge something my audience believes
- 6 that show my actual work or process
- 4 that are pure proof (results, client wins, before and after)
- 2 that are just me being a person

Rules: no generic "5 tips" topics. Every idea must be specific enough that a competitor couldn't post the identical thing. If an idea works for any business in any industry, replace it.

Tip: run this once a month, approve as many as you need, park the rest.

07 THE VIDEO-TO-SHORTS MINER

Fixes: one long video sat there doing nothing.

Use in: ChatGPT or Claude. Paste a transcript.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's the transcript of a [X]-minute video I recorded. Find the 8 strongest short-form moments in it.

For each one give me:

- The full clip script in one block of text, and how you want me to stitch it. Remember I cannot invent video, it has already been recorded, so you need to just crop the parts that are in the video in a clever way.
- The new short should be 30 to 90 seconds long. Calculate as 2 to 3 words per second.
- Why it stands alone (one line)
- A written text hook for the first 3 seconds, since the original opening won't work cold. 5 words max.

Rank them strongest first. Be honest: if fewer than 8 are genuinely good, tell me and give me only the good ones.

TRANSCRIPT:

[paste]

Tip: this turns one recording session into two weeks of content.

08 THE CAROUSEL BUILDER

Fixes: carousels that are just a blog post chopped up.

Use in: ChatGPT.

COPY THIS PROMPT

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Build a [8 / 10]-slide carousel on: [topic]

Audience: [who]

The single takeaway: [one sentence]

For each slide give me:

- Headline (6 words max, large text)
- Body (max 20 words, or none)
- Visual direction (one line for my designer)

Structure:

- Slide 1: the hook. Must work alone in the feed with no context.
- Slide 2: name the problem in their words
- Slides 3 to [n-2]: one idea per slide, each one moving forward, no repetition
- Second to last: the summary they'll screenshot
- Last: what to do next, stated plainly

Rules: nothing continues across slides. Each slide must be understandable on its own. No slide exists just to say "keep swiping".

Then build the slides one at a time. Wait for the copy to come back and polish any messaging you want to change. Once you're happy, go one by one: "now generate slide 1", "now generate slide 2", and so on.

Editing tip for ChatGPT: when you want to change a graphic it's already generated, always click the edit button on that image rather than asking in the chat. It makes sure the edit lands on the right image. Once you're in edit mode, click comment in the top right corner and leave your note on the specific element you want changed.

09 THE UGC-STYLE AD SCRIPT

Fixes: ads that look like ads and get scrolled past.

Use in: ChatGPT or Claude. Then film it, or generate it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write 3 UGC-style video ad scripts for [product or service].

What it is: [one line]

Who it's for: [specific person, not a demographic]

The problem it solves: [the real one, in their words]

Price: [X]

Proof I have: [reviews, results, numbers, before and after]

Each script: 30 to 40 seconds spoken. Format as a two-column table: SPOKEN LINE | WHAT'S ON SCREEN.

Three different structures:

1. Problem to solution: open on the frustration, mid-way reveal, end on the result
2. Straight recommendation: someone telling a friend, no sales language at all
3. Before and after: show the old way, show the new way, no explanation needed

Rules:

- First 3 seconds must show something, not say something
- Say the price out loud in scripts 1 and 3
- No "hey guys", no "so I found this", no "trust me"
- One benefit per script, not a feature list
- End with a specific next step, not "link in bio"

Tip: read them out loud before you approve anything. Some lines read well and sound daft out loud, nothing like the way a real person talks.

10 THE SCENE BUILDER

Fixes: having one product photo and needing twenty pieces of content.

Use in: ChatGPT (image generation), with your product photo uploaded.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's my product. Generate 5 different lifestyle scenes using it, keeping the product identical in every one.

CRITICAL: same product, same label, same colours, same proportions in all 5. Nothing invented, nothing redesigned.

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Scene 1: [morning routine, natural window light, warm]

Scene 2: [in use, hands in frame, mid-action, slightly imperfect]

Scene 3: [flat lay from directly above, with 2 or 3 complementary objects]

Scene 4: [outdoors, golden hour, shallow depth of field]

Scene 5: [minimal, single colour backdrop, editorial, lots of negative space]

Across all five:

- Consistent colour grade so they work as a grid
- Real-world lighting, natural shadows, no studio perfection. It has to look realistic, not too polished.
- No text, no logos added, no watermarks
- Format: [4:5 / 1:1 / 9:16]

Generate scene 1 now

Then keep going: "generate scene 2 now", and so on through all five.

Tip: set all five scenes out in the first message even though you generate them one at a time. That's what keeps the colour grade consistent, so they look like one shoot when they sit together in the grid.

11 THE NEWSLETTER THAT GETS OPENED

Fixes: the email you keep meaning to send.

Use in: ChatGPT or Claude.

COPY THIS PROMPT

VOICE PROFILE:

[paste from prompt 03]

Write this week's email.

What happened / what I want to say: [rough notes, messy is fine]

Who's reading: [your list, honestly]

Where I want them to go: [one link, one action]

Structure:

- 5 subject lines. Specific and curious, under 45 characters, no clickbait, no emoji, no colons doing heavy lifting.
- Preview text for each (it must add to the subject, not repeat it)
- Body: 200 to 300 words. Open mid-thought like a message to one person. One idea. One link, placed once, in context.
- Sign off the way I'd sign off, not the way a brand would.

Rules: no "hope you're well", no "quick one", no recapping what the email is about before the email starts. Just start.

Tip: write to one specific customer by name in your head. It changes everything.

12 THE REVIEW THAT LOOKS DESIGNED

Fixes: great reviews sitting in your inbox as ugly screenshots you'd never post.

Use in: ChatGPT (image generation), with the screenshot uploaded.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I'm attaching a screenshot of a real review a customer left me.

Turn it into a branded testimonial graphic for [Instagram feed 4:5 / story 9:16 / LinkedIn 1:1].

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Rules:

- Use the review text exactly as written. Do not rewrite it, tidy it, correct the grammar or make it sound better. Real wording is the whole point. If it's too long, cut from the end and keep the strongest lines, but change nothing you keep.
- Pull out the single strongest phrase and set it much larger than the rest, as the headline.
- Show the reviewer's first name and last initial only. Add [5 stars / their job title / their town] underneath if it's in the screenshot.
- Use ONLY my brand colours and my brand typography. No other colours, no other fonts.
- No fake phone frames, no fake app interfaces, no quotation-mark clip art, no gradients, no drop shadows on text.
- Text must fill at least 60% of the graphic. Big, high contrast, readable at thumbnail size.
- Flat and clean. It should look like a designer laid it out, not like a screenshot with a filter on it.

Generate now

ADD-ON · SAME CHAT

Now give me one more from the same review, pulling out a different phrase as the headline, in the same layout so the two work as a set.

13 THE PHOTO YOU ALREADY HAVE, FIXED

Fixes: the photo that's actually fine apart from the yellow light, the messy background and the bins in the corner.

Use in: ChatGPT, with your photo uploaded.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here's a photo I took on my phone. Fix the photography without changing what's in it.

CRITICAL: this is a real photo of a real place / person / product. Keep everything that matters exactly as it is: same faces, same product, same room, same layout, same signage, same text on anything visible. Do not add objects, do not remove anything I'd notice, do not restyle the space.

Fix only these:

- Lighting: remove the yellow or green colour cast, balance it to natural daylight, lift the shadows so detail comes back, pull down anything blown out
- Clutter: remove only genuine background rubbish (bins, cables, stray boxes, clutter on surfaces behind the subject). If you're not sure whether something is meant to be there, leave it.
- Sharpness: clean up phone-camera softness and noise without making it look processed
- Colour: true to life, slightly warm, no HDR, no heavy saturation
- Straighten the horizon and fix any lens distortion

It must still look like a phone photo taken by a real person on a good day. Not a render, not a stock photo, not airbrushed. Someone who was in that room should recognise it immediately.

Then give me the same image cropped to [4:5 / 1:1 / 9:16].

Generate now

Tip: works on shop interiors, team photos, food, before-and-afters, event photos. Anything where reshooting means going back somewhere.

Tip: read the prompt before you send it. If you do want people or objects removed, say so. You can always adapt it to your situation.

14 THE OFFER GRAPHIC WITH THE PRICE ON IT

Fixes: promos, menus and price lists that either look homemade or hide the price.

Use in: ChatGPT (image generation).

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a promotional graphic for [Instagram feed 4:5 / story 9:16 / poster A4].

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

The offer: [what it is]

The price: [X] [and what it was before, if relevant]

Who it's for: [one line]

When it ends: [date, or leave blank]

What they do next: [book / call / DM / come in]

Layout rules:

- Three levels of text and no more. The offer is the biggest thing on the graphic. The price is second. Everything else is small.
- The price must be readable at thumbnail size on a phone. If it doesn't survive being shrunk to the size of a stamp, it's too small.
- One clear next step at the bottom, short and specific. No "link in bio".
- Use ONLY my brand colours and my brand typography.
- Any photo is background support only, never the focus, and never sat on top with the text underneath.
- No starbursts, no fake price tags, no clip-art badges, no explosions, no discount stickers.
- Plenty of empty space. Crowded means cheap.

Generate now

PROMPT CONTINUES ON THE NEXT PAGE →

14 THE OFFER GRAPHIC WITH THE PRICE ON IT — CONTINUED

ADD-ON

Now give me the story version at 9:16 with the same hierarchy, and keep the top and bottom 15% of the frame clear so nothing important sits under the interface.

Tip: go back to ChatGPT with any extra edits you need. Keep it in the same chat.

15 THE PROFILE THAT MAKES SENSE IN 3 SECONDS

Fixes: a bio that explains nothing and a profile people leave without following.
Use in: ChatGPT or Claude.

COPY THIS PROMPT

BRAND KIT:

[paste your Brand Kit]

Rewrite my [Instagram / TikTok / LinkedIn] profile.

What I actually do: [in plain words, as you'd say it to a stranger in a pub]

Who I do it for: [specific]

What I want people to do: [follow / book / buy / DM a keyword]

Where I am: [if it matters to buyers]

Give me:

- 5 bio options, each under 150 characters, each one making it obvious what I do and who for within the first 4 words
- A name-field version, under 30 characters, written for search, not for style
- One line for the link, under 40 characters, telling them what they'll get if they tap
- 6 highlight or featured-section titles, one word each

Rules: no "helping you to", no "passionate about", no emoji-as-bullet-points unless my brand kit says emoji, no job titles nobody searches for. Say the thing plainly. Someone who has never heard of me should understand the offer without scrolling.

Then tell me in one line which bio you'd pick and why.

THE PART MOST PEOPLE SKIP.

Three habits make the difference between output that works and output that looks like everyone else's:

Give it your Brand Kit every time.

Generic in, generic out. The five minutes you spent on getting started is doing all the heavy lifting.

Tell it what you hate.

The banned-words lists in these prompts aren't decoration. They're the reason the writing stops sounding generic.

Never post the first draft.

AI gets you 80% of the way in 20 seconds. The last 20% is you, and it's the only part your audience can tell apart. Give it feedback, let it learn. Use the same chat for the same prompts so everything stays consistent.

WANT THE MACHINE, NOT JUST THE PROMPTS?

These 15 prompts are the manual version. The same thinking, wired into automations, turns one video into a fortnight of content while you get on with the actual work.

That's what we build.

Book an AI discovery call